

EVIDENCE REPORT — UNIDENTIFIED DOCUMENT

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT. Document not in custody. Existence and location unconfirmed. Based on historical references only.

DESIGNATION	Unidentified Document — Provisional designation: "Cormsil Compact" (Object of Interest: Cormsil, Yorkshire)
PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION (INFERRED)	Based on a single historical reference — a brass display label at the Cormsil Public Library reading "Cormsil Compact, 1882 — On Permanent Loan from the Town Council" — a document of some kind was created or signed in Cormsil in 1882. Its physical form is unknown. If it is a typical 19th-century legal or civic document, it would likely be handwritten on paper or vellum, possibly with signatures, seals, or other authentication marks. The document was reportedly displayed in a glass case in the Cormsil Public Library prior to the fire. The case is now empty. The document's current location is unknown — it may have been: destroyed in the fire; removed before the fire; removed after the fire; or transferred at some earlier date without the display label being updated. The document's content, authorship, purpose, and signatories are unknown.
PROVENANCE (PRELIMINARY)	The document — if it existed — was reportedly created in Cormsil in 1882. The brass label attributes it to "The Society" (organization unidentified — see Organization Reference). The document was described as "on permanent loan from the Town Council," suggesting it was a civic document of some kind, entrusted to the library for public display. The document's creation coincides with the incumbency of Reverend Arthur Hailes (Vicar of Cormsil, 1876-1891), whose personal papers — including a sealed letter to the Bishop of Ripon dated 1883 — are held at the Bodleian Library, Oxford. The temporal proximity (1882 compact, 1883 sealed letter) is noted. No other historical references to this document have been located in public records.

ANOMALOUS CHARACTERISTICS

The document itself has not been examined. Its anomalous characteristics — if any — are unknown. The circumstances surrounding the document are, however, unusual:

The document was reportedly on public display in a small rural library for an unknown duration. A document of civic significance would typically be held in a county archive or record office, not a village library. The "permanent loan" arrangement is unusual — most civic documents of legal significance are not loaned to small public libraries for display.

The document's display case survived the fire sufficiently for its brass label to remain legible, but the case is empty. Whether the document was removed before, during, or after the fire is unknown. If it was present during the fire, it may

have been destroyed — paper and vellum are highly combustible. If it was removed, the timing and agent of removal are significant questions.

The 1883 sealed letter from Vicar Hailes to the Bishop of Ripon — held unopened at the Bodleian — is temporally adjacent to the 1882 compact. A vicar writing a sealed, unsent letter to his bishop the year after a civic compact was signed is a behavioral anomaly worth investigating. The letter's content is unknown.

HANDLING ADVISORY

Recommendation: If the document is located, handle with gloved hands using standard archival protocols for 19th-century paper. Iron gall ink — standard for the period — is acidic and the paper may be fragile. Do not attempt to separate stuck pages. Do not fold, roll, or apply pressure to the document.

The document should be treated as a potential historical artifact of investigative interest. Its content — if recoverable — may provide context for current events in Cormsil. There is no reason to believe the document itself is hazardous; it is assessed as a paper document of historical significance.

Advisory: The document has not been located or examined. Its existence is inferred from a brass display label — it is possible the document was removed or destroyed decades ago and the label was never updated. Do not assume the document is recoverable. Historical research into the 1882 compact may yield information even if the physical document cannot be located.

INVESTIGATION STATUS

The document — if it exists — has not been located. Possible locations include: the crypt of St. Cuthbert's Church (the vicar of the period may have stored it there); the Bodleian Library (among Vicar Hailes's papers); private holdings of a Cormsil resident; destroyed in the library fire; or in an unknown location entirely. The document's content, signatories, and purpose are unknown and under historical investigation.

Related lines of inquiry: the sealed 1883 Hailes letter at the Bodleian Library (Oxford); the parish records of St. Cuthbert's Church (Cormsil); the 17th-century Colne manuscript at the British Library (London); and any surviving records of

"The Society" — the unidentified organization that reportedly created the compact.

This report is a preliminary evidence assessment only. Conclusions are provisional.

The document described may not exist or may have been destroyed. All inferences are based on a single historical reference.

Distribution outside assigned cell requires Watch Commander authorization.

Classification: SECRET — Clearance Level 2+